

Khanh Duong (Kevin)

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Research interests: **Familial Relationship Goods, Social Norms, Causal Inference**
For all publications, the associated data and code are made openly available on GitHub or Figshare.

Education

Maastricht University, the Netherlands (with external fellowship) Sep 2024 – Sep 2026
PhD in Economics

- Supervisors: Prof. Wim Groot (Maastricht) and Prof. Kristof De Witte (KU Leuven)
- External fellowship with [United Nations University–MERIT](#)
- Dissertation: “The role of family relationships in intergenerational inequality in education”
- Completed PhD within 2 years, including public defence (see [my reflection](#))
- Interdisciplinary: Economics (main), Sociology, Political Philosophy, Behaviour Genetics
- Approaches: Twin design, adoption design, IV reforms, causal machine learning
- Operationalized “Familial Relationship Goods”
- Developed a method correcting gene–environment interplay bias (rGE and GxE)

University of Turku, Finland (with employment) Jan 2026 – Expected 2027
PhD Inequalities, Interventions and New Welfare State (DPInvest)

- Supervisors: Prof. Jani Erola, Dr. Hannu Lehti
- Dissertation: “The paradox of meritocracy: efforts, norms, and gender”
- Employed by [INVEST Research Flagship Centre](#)
- DPInvest is my second (separate from Maastricht) with institutional approval
- Interdisciplinary: Sociology (main), Psychology, Economics

Maynooth University, Ireland (with grant) Sep 2021 – Sep 2023
Master by Research (M.Litt) in Sociology

- Supervisors: Dr. Eoin Flaherty, Prof. Seán Ó Riain
- Fully funded by the Irish Research Council under award number GOIPG/2021/441
- Thesis: [The Roles of Poverty and Inequality as Factors in the Impact of Climate Change](#)
- Publication in [Economic Change and Restructuring](#)

Foreign Trade University, HCMC Campus, Vietnam Sep 2012 – Apr 2016
Bachelor of International Business Economics

- GPA of 81.1%, high marks in Advanced Mathematics and Business Analytics
- Thesis: The impact of trade openness on the unemployment rate of Vietnam
- Third Prize at the HCM City–level Competition on Effective University Learning Methods

Honors and awards

Research Fellowship Sep 2024
United Nations University–MERIT, Maastricht, Netherlands

- Project: Advancing the study of socio–economic inequality: A new analytical approach
- Supervisors: Prof. Wim Groot (Maastricht University) and Prof. Kristof De Witte (KU Leuven)

Government of Ireland Postgraduate Research Scholarship Sep 2021
Irish Research Council, Ireland

- Project: The impact of globalization on the unemployment rate in the Asia–Pacific region
- Funding amount: €55,000.00 for two years of master’s degree

Homeworks Summer Climate Action Residency Jun 2023
Community Climate Action Programme

- Hosted by The Common Knowledge Centre in The Burren, County Clare, Ireland
- Co–created a toolkit designed to facilitate climate action at the household level.

Selected presentations

ECSR–CA–NASP Joint Spring School at Collegio Carlo Alberto

Turin, Italy

What Should Perfect Mobility Look Like?

Mar 2026

- Discussant: Prof. Fabrizio Bernardi (UNED, Madrid)
- Highly selected via a competitive international application process

Selected publications

- Duong, K. (2026). Measuring norm strength: The specificity of fairness under meritocracy in europe [Operationalize norm specificity (conceptual innovation) and use Hierarchical MDS (methodological adaption), see [my reflection](#) [🔗](#)]. *Acta Psychologica*, 266, 106859.
- Duong, K. (2025). If inequality is an economic choice, what is the relationship between inequality and growth? [Conceptualize inevitable inequality and employ multiobjective optimization algorithms in operations research, see [my reflection](#) [🔗](#)]. *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, 74(2025), 116–128.
- Duong, K. (2024). Is meritocracy just? new evidence from boolean analysis and machine learning [Novel approach with true–false logic (in philosophy) and causal machine learning]. *Journal of Computational Social Science*, 7(2), 1795–1821.
- Duong, K. (2024). What really matters for global intergenerational mobility? [Media coverage by [EurekAlert](#) [🔗](#) and [Mirage News](#) [🔗](#)]. *PLOS ONE*, 19(6), e0302173.
- Duong, K., & Flaherty, E. (2023). Does growth reduce poverty? the mediating role of carbon emissions and income inequality [Based on my research master’s thesis using generalized method of moments]. *Economic Change and Restructuring*, 56(5), 3309–3334.
- Nguyen, D. P., Vo, X. V., Nguyen, V. C., Mai, X. D., & Duong, Q. K. (2021). Sustainable development for vietnam’s economy in the context of globalization and industrial revolution 4.0. In *Sustainability and environmental decision making* (pp. 281–310). Springer Singapore.

Working papers

- What makes a family a family? The inevitable inequality in intergenerational educational transmission (*with Prof. Wim Groot and Prof. Kristof De Witte*). [In Doctoral dissertation, Chaps. 2–3].
- What should perfect mobility look like? Fair progress in the intergenerational mobility in education (*with Prof. Wim Groot and Prof. Kristof De Witte*). [In Doctoral dissertation, Chap. 4].
- The price of protecting family relationships for educational mobility (*with Prof. Wim Groot and Prof. Kristof De Witte*). [In Doctoral dissertation, Chap. 5].
- Gender–equality paradox under meritocracy: Measuring gender specialization across societies (*with Prof. Jani Erola and Dr. Hannu Lehti*). [Norm specificity to explain the relationship between meritocracy and gender paradox].

Industry experience

Generative AI data annotator (full–time)

Dublin, Ireland

Covalen (*on–site at Meta*)

Feb 2024 — Sep 2024

- Annotated English data accurately per guidelines, processing 100+ tickets daily.
- Evaluated data quality and machine learning outputs.
- Maintained annotation guidelines and attended 1–2 training sessions weekly.

Research Executive (full–time)

HCMC, Vietnam

Indochina Research

Mar 2021 — Sep 2021

- Led the TRAFFIC project (wildlife animal products in Vietnam) N = 600
- Monitored the WHO project (COVID–awareness in Vietnam) N = 1500
- Designed and scripted questionnaires by Survey–Togo (a survey Platform)
- Conducted data analysis with SPSS & STATA, and Q–research
- Wrote final reports and described research methodologies

Research Officer (part–time)

HCMC, Vietnam

UEH Institute of Business Research

Nov 2020 — Sep 2021

- Published a [peer–reviewed book chapter](#) [🔗](#) in Springer, Singapore.

- Completed two working papers on sustainable development
- Drafted one national research funding application.

Import–Export Executive (full–time)

Nam Viet Corporation

An Giang, Vietnam

Aug 2018 — Oct 2020

- Completed customs procedure to +50 countries with 300+ containers/ month
- Drafted 100+ sale contracts/ months with various payment terms (L/C, D/P, D/A)
- Supervised supply chains: quality testing, packaging, logistics

Property–Engineering Underwriter (full–time)

Global Insurance Corporation

HCMC, Vietnam

Jul 2016 — Jul 2018

- Underwrote 200+ insurance inquiries per month with 15+ different insurance products
- Wrote 5+ reports per month: Revenue and Claim reports, Reports of Business efficiency
- Participated in the UI design project for the core system with an international partner’s team

Research skills

Programming skills: QUARTO, Jupyter, Markdown for reproducible research (good), CRAN–R (expert), Stata (expert), Python (beginner), SPSS (good, but no longer used), L^AT_EX (good), Word–Excel–PowerPoint (expert), Power BI (good, but no longer used), SureyTogo (good, but no longer used), GitHub, WordPress, Blogger.

Experience with Datasets: European Social Survey (ESS), World Values Survey (WVS), Longitudinal Internet Studies for the Social Sciences (LISS) panel — Netherlands, Cross–National Online Survey (CRONOS), Luxembourg Income Study (LIS), Standardized World Income Inequality Database (SWIID), Penn World Table (PWT), World Bank Open Data (WDI), Global Database on Intergenerational Mobility (GDIM), Wisconsin Longitudinal Study (WLS), International Social Survey Programme (ISSP)

Quantitative methods: Randomized controlled trial, Difference in Difference, Regression Discontinuity Design, Sample Selection (Heckman), Instrumental Variables, Time–series Analysis, Panel Data Analysis, Structural Equation Modelling, Causal Machine Learning, Generalized Random Forests, Social Network Analysis, Textual analysis, and Simulation.

Soft skills: Funding application, Time management, Project management, Teamwork, Critical thinking, [Academic writing](#) , Philosophical reasoning, and Self–learning.

Languages: Vietnamese: Native; English: C1 (equivalent)

Scholarly participation

Peer–review: Economic Change and Restructuring; Economics of Innovation and New Technology; Social Science Quarterly; Environment, Development and Sustainability; PLOS ONE; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Applied Research in Quality of Life; Structural Change and Economic Dynamics

Academic membership: Society for the Advancement of Socioeconomics; Maynooth University Social Science Institute; European Consortium for Sociological Research

Referees

Prof. Wim Groot, Professor of Health Economics and Evidence–Based Education

Maastricht University and UNU–MERIT, ✉ w.groot@maastrichtuniversity.nl

Prof. Kristof De Witte, Vice–Dean and Professor of Education Economics and Political Economy

Faculty of Economics and Business, KU Leuven, ✉ kristof.dewitte@kuleuven.be

Prof. Jani Erola, Academy Professor in Sociology, Director of INVEST Research Flagship Centre

Faculty of Social Science, University of Turku, ✉ jani.erola@utu.fi

Dr. Hannu Lehti, Academy Research Fellow in Sociology, INVEST Research Flagship Centre

Faculty of Social Science, University of Turku, ✉ hpleht@utu.fi